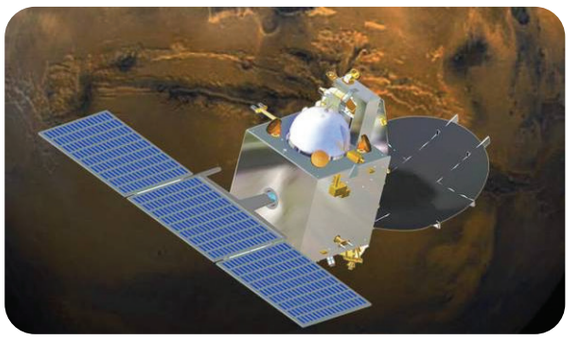
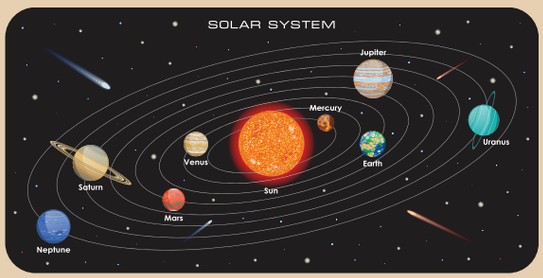


Figure 8.7 Mangalyaan

Mars Orbiter Mission (MOM) successfully completed a period of 3 years in the Martian orbit and continues to work as expected. ISRO has released the scientific data received from the Mangalyaan in the past two years (up to September 2016).

More to know

Mars is the fourth planet from the Sun. It is the second smallest planet in the solar system. Mars is called as the Red Planet because of its reddish colour. Iron oxide present in its surface and also in its dusty atmosphere gives the reddish colour to that planet. Mars rotates about its own axis once in 24 hours 37 minutes. Mars revolves around the Sun once in 687 days. The rotational period and seasonal cycles of Mars are similar to that of the Earth. Astronomers are more curious in the exploration of Mars. So, they have sent many unmanned spacecrafts to study the planet's surface, climate, and geology.



Activity 4

Gather information about the planets in the solar system. Can we reach all the planets in the solar system? Discuss in the class room.

a. Objectives of Mangalyaan

The following are the objectives of Mangalyaan mission.

- To develop the technology required for interplanetary mission.
- To explore the surface of Mars.
- To study the constituents of the atmosphere of Mars.
- To provide information about the future possibility of life and past existence of life on the planet.



Figure 8.8 Image from Mars Orbiter Mission

DO YOU KNOW?

India became the first Asian country to reach Mars and the first nation in the world to achieve this in the first attempt. Soviet Space Program, NASA, and European Space Agency are the three other agencies that reached Mars before ISRO.

8.2.3 Chandrayaan - 2

ISRO launched a follow on mission to Chandrayaan-1 named as Chandrayaan-2, on 22nd July 2019. Chandrayaan-2 mission is highly complex mission compared to previous missions of ISRO. It brought together an Orbiter, Lander and Rover. It aims to explore the South Pole region of the Moon because the surface area of the South Pole remaines in shadow much larger than that of North Pole.

Orbiter

It revolves around the Moon and it is capable of communicating with Indian Deep Space Network (IDSN) at Bylalu, Karnataka as well as Vikram Lander.

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